

Electronic keyboards

The keys of an electronic keyboard activate digital sound modules, producing a huge range of sampled sounds and musical effects at the touch of a button. They usually have a single keyboard, or “manual,” and a selection of switches, “stops,” to alter the tone color of a melody, play preselected harmonies, or add a rhythmic drumbeat effect.



◁ **Transformation**
Versatile, compact, portable, and affordable, electronic keyboards have transformed music composition and performance since the 1960s.

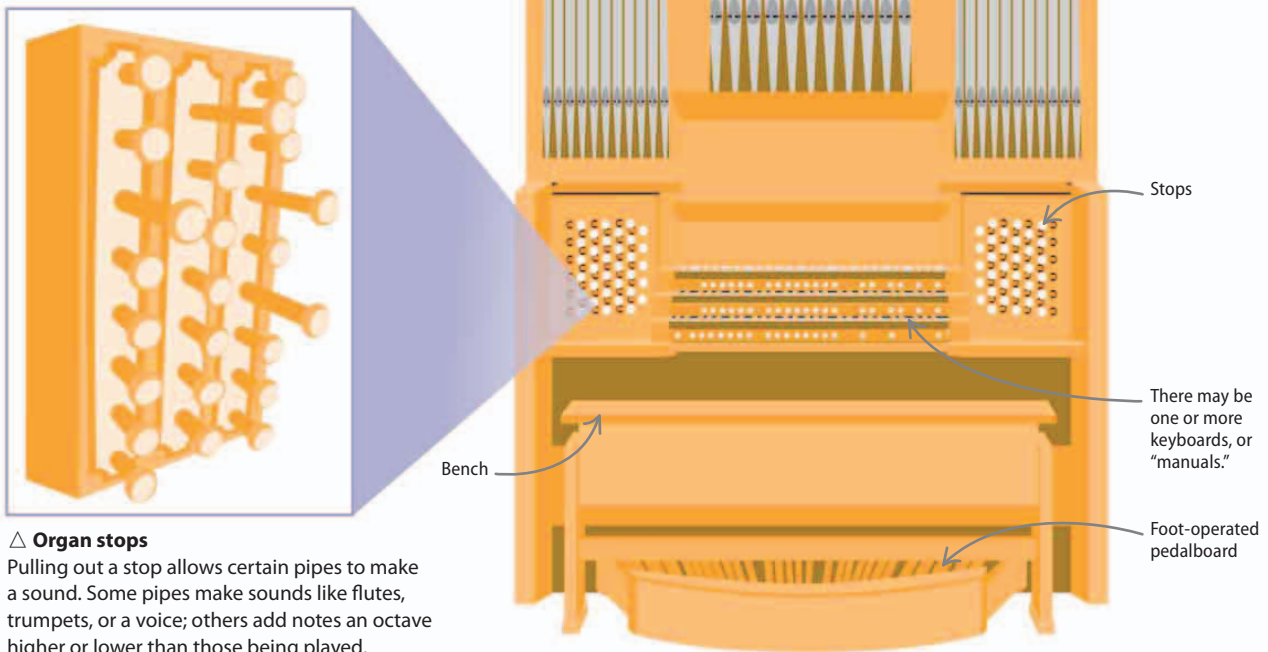
Organ

The pipe organ is a box of whistles sounded by the air blown from a windchest. It is played from one or more keyboards, or “manuals,” and a pedalboard. Air is allowed into the pipes by pulling out the “stops.” The pipes are arranged in “ranks,” each producing a different kind of sound and pitch range.

“For my eyes and ears, the **organ** is the **king of instruments.**” Mozart, 1777

▷ Small pipe organ

While many organs are built into buildings and powered by electricity, the 18th-century organ (still replicated today) is often freestanding, using electricity only to power the windchest.



△ Organ stops

Pulling out a stop allows certain pipes to make a sound. Some pipes make sounds like flutes, trumpets, or a voice; others add notes an octave higher or lower than those being played.